Risk register

Operational environment:

The bank is located in a coastal area with low crime rates. Many people and systems handle the bank's data—100 on-premise employees and 20 remote employees. The customer base of the bank includes 2,000 individual accounts and 200 commercial accounts. The bank's services are marketed by a professional sports team and ten local businesses in the community. There are strict financial regulations that require the bank to secure their data and funds, like having enough cash available each day to meet Federal Reserve requirements.

Asset	Risk(s)	Description	Likelihood	Severity	Priority
Funds	Business email compromise	*An employee is tricked into sharing confidential information.*	3	3	9
	Compromised user database	*Customer data is poorly encrypted.*	2	3	6
	Financial records leak	*A database server of backed up data is publicly accessible.*	3	3	9
	Theft	*The bank's safe is left unlocked.*	1	3	3
	Supply chain disruption	*Delivery delays due to natural disasters.*	2	2	4
Notes	**Business Email Compromise:** With 120 employees, including 20 remote workers, the bank has an expanded attack surface. Remote access and regular email communication increase the likelihood of phishing attacks that could trick employees into disclosing sensitive information. **Compromised User Database:** If encryption is improperly implemented or misconfigured, sensitive customer data could be exposed. Human error, weak configuration management, or insufficient oversight can create exploitable vulnerabilities despite regulatory requirements.				

	Financial Records Leak: A publicly accessible backup server can be discovered through automated internet scanning tools. Without proper access controls or firewall restrictions, attackers could obtain sensitive financial records. **Theft:** Even in a low-crime area, insider threats or procedural lapses (such as leaving a safe unlocked) create opportunities for physical theft of funds. **Supply Chain Disruption:** The bank's coastal location increases the likelihood of severe weather events that could delay deliveries, disrupt operations, or impact availability of essential resources.

Asset: The asset at risk of being harmed, damaged, or stolen.
Risk(s): A potential risk to the organization's information systems and data.
Description: A vulnerability that might lead to a security incident.
Likelihood: Score from 1-3 of the chances of a vulnerability being exploited. A 1 means there's a low likelihood, a 2 means there's a moderate likelihood, and a 3 means there's a high likelihood.
Severity: Score from 1-3 of the potential damage the threat would cause to the business. A 1 means a low severity impact, a 2 is a moderate severity impact, and a 3 is a high severity impact.
Priority: How quickly a risk should be addressed to avoid the potential incident. Use the following formula to calculate the overall score: **Likelihood x Impact Severity = Risk**

Sample risk matrix

Likelihood	Severity: Low 1	Severity: Moderate 2	Severity: Catastrophic 3
Certain 3	3	6	9
Likely 2	2	4	6
Rare 1	1	2	3